GLOUCESTER
ZAKAT FUND
CHARITY FOR LOCAL RESIDENTS

VOLUNTEER MANAGEMENT POLICY

Document Information	
Policy Name	Volunteer Management Policy
Version	1.0
Policy Owner	Board of Trustees
Approved by	Board of Trustees
Date Approved	01/02/2026
Next Review Date	01/02/2028
Related Policies	Safeguarding Policy, Equality Diversity and Inclusion Policy, Expenses Policy, Data Protection Policy, Complaints Policy

1. Introduction

Gloucester Zakat Charity ("the Charity") is a Charitable Incorporated Organisation established to prevent and relieve poverty and financial hardship in Gloucestershire and the wider United Kingdom, with a particular focus on members of the Muslim community. The Charity collects and distributes Zakat (obligatory Islamic almsgiving) and Sadaqah (voluntary charity) to eligible beneficiaries.

The Charity is entirely volunteer-run and does not employ any paid staff. Volunteers are therefore essential to the Charity's work, and their contribution is highly valued. This policy sets out how the Charity recruits, supports, and manages its volunteers to ensure a positive experience for volunteers and effective delivery of the Charity's charitable purposes.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Establish clear principles and procedures for volunteer management
- Ensure a fair, consistent, and positive experience for all volunteers
- Protect volunteers, beneficiaries, and the Charity
- Comply with relevant legislation and best practice
- Recognise and value the contribution that volunteers make
- Support the effective delivery of the Charity's charitable purposes

3. Scope

This policy applies to all volunteers of the Charity, including trustees (who are also volunteers). It covers the full volunteer journey from recruitment through to departure.

4. Principles

The Charity is committed to the following principles in its management of volunteers:

- Volunteers give their time freely and are not paid for their contribution
- Volunteering is a two-way relationship that should benefit both the volunteer and the Charity
- Volunteers will be treated fairly, with respect, and in accordance with the Charity's values
- Volunteers will not be used to replace paid staff or to undertake work that should be done by employees
- Volunteers will receive appropriate support, training, and supervision
- The Charity welcomes volunteers from all backgrounds and is committed to equal opportunities

5. Volunteer Roles

Volunteers may be involved in a range of activities depending on the Charity's needs and their skills and availability. Examples of volunteer roles include:

- **Beneficiary assessment:** Assisting with meetings to assess eligibility for Zakat or Sadaqah support
- **Administration:** Supporting record-keeping, correspondence, and general administration
- **Fundraising:** Assisting with fundraising activities and campaigns
- **Events:** Helping to organise and run events
- **Communications:** Supporting social media, website updates, or marketing materials
- **Partner liaison:** Working with partner organisations to coordinate support for beneficiaries

The Board will maintain a list of current volunteer roles and their requirements.

6. Recruitment

Volunteer recruitment will be conducted in a fair, transparent, and non-discriminatory manner:

- Volunteer opportunities will be advertised through appropriate channels, such as the Charity's website, social media, local mosques, and community networks
- Recruitment will be open to all, subject to any specific requirements of the role
- Prospective volunteers will be provided with information about the role, time commitment, and what is expected of them
- Prospective volunteers may be asked to complete an application form and/or attend an informal interview
- The Charity aims to match volunteers to roles that suit their skills, interests, and availability

7. Screening and Checks

Appropriate screening will be carried out for all volunteers, proportionate to the nature of the role:

- **Identity verification:** All volunteers will be asked to confirm their identity
- **References:** References may be sought for volunteers in roles involving significant responsibility or contact with vulnerable people
- **DBS checks:** Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks will be required for volunteers whose roles involve regular unsupervised contact with children or adults at risk, or home visits to beneficiaries. The Safeguarding Policy sets out which roles require DBS checks

Volunteers must not begin their role until all required checks have been satisfactorily completed.

8. Induction and Training

All volunteers will receive an induction to familiarise them with the Charity. The induction will cover:

- The Charity's mission, values, and charitable purposes
- An overview of the Charity's activities and how it operates

- Key policies, including Safeguarding, Data Protection, and Equality Diversity and Inclusion
- Health and safety information
- Their specific role and what is expected of them
- Who they should contact with questions or concerns
- How to claim expenses

Additional training relevant to specific roles will be provided as needed. For example, volunteers involved in beneficiary assessments may receive training on Zakat eligibility criteria and conducting assessments sensitively.

9. Volunteer Agreement

Volunteers are not employees and do not have an employment contract. However, to clarify mutual expectations, volunteers may be asked to sign a Volunteer Agreement which sets out:

- A description of the volunteer role
- The expected time commitment
- What the Charity will provide (induction, training, support, expenses)
- What is expected of the volunteer (conduct, confidentiality, attendance)
- The named trustee contact for the volunteer

The Volunteer Agreement is not intended to create a legally binding contract and does not create an employment relationship.

10. Code of Conduct

Volunteers are expected to:

- Act with honesty and integrity
- Treat everyone with respect and courtesy
- Follow the Charity's policies and procedures
- Maintain confidentiality about beneficiaries, donors, and sensitive Charity information
- Declare any conflicts of interest
- Behave in a manner that does not bring the Charity into disrepute
- Carry out their role to the best of their ability
- Attend as agreed and give reasonable notice if unable to fulfil a commitment
- Raise any concerns through appropriate channels

11. Support and Supervision

Volunteers will receive appropriate support and supervision:

- Each volunteer will have a named trustee as their main point of contact
- The trustee contact will provide guidance, answer questions, and offer regular check-ins
- Open communication will be maintained so volunteers feel comfortable raising concerns or providing feedback
- Volunteers will be given constructive feedback on their contribution
- The Board will periodically review how volunteers are being supported

12. Health and Safety

The safety and wellbeing of volunteers is a priority:

- The Charity will take reasonable steps to ensure a safe environment for volunteers
- Volunteers will be informed of relevant health and safety procedures
- Risk assessments will be carried out for activities where appropriate
- Volunteers should report any health and safety concerns to their trustee contact
- Volunteers must follow health and safety guidance provided

13. Equal Opportunities

The Charity is committed to providing equal opportunities for volunteers regardless of age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage and civil partnership, pregnancy and maternity, race, religion or belief, sex, or sexual orientation. The Charity's Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policy applies to volunteers.

14. Expenses

Volunteers give their time freely, but the Charity does not expect volunteers to be out of pocket. Volunteers may claim reasonable expenses incurred while carrying out their volunteer duties:

- Travel expenses (public transport fares or mileage at an agreed rate)
- Subsistence costs where appropriate
- Other reasonable costs agreed in advance

All expense claims must be submitted with receipts and approved by a trustee. Full details are set out in the Charity's Expenses Policy.

15. Recognition

The Charity is committed to recognising and appreciating the contribution of volunteers:

- Volunteers will be thanked for their contribution
- Recognition may include thank-you letters, certificates, or acknowledgment in Charity communications
- The Charity may hold occasional events to thank volunteers
- References may be provided for volunteers who request them

16. Concerns and Grievances

The Charity aims to provide a positive volunteer experience, but recognises that problems can sometimes arise:

- Volunteers are encouraged to raise any concerns informally with their trustee contact in the first instance
- If the concern cannot be resolved informally, or if it is serious, the volunteer may raise a formal complaint under the Charity's Complaints Policy
- Volunteers will not be treated unfairly for raising genuine concerns in good faith

If a volunteer's conduct falls short of expectations, the trustee contact will discuss this with them informally. In cases of serious misconduct, or where informal discussions do not resolve the issue, the Board may ask the volunteer to leave their role.

17. Leaving

Volunteers may leave their role at any time. When a volunteer decides to leave:

- The Charity asks for reasonable notice where possible, to allow for handover
- Volunteers will be asked to return any Charity property or materials
- Volunteers may be invited to provide feedback through an informal exit conversation
- The Charity will thank volunteers for their contribution

18. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Volunteers must:

- Respect the confidentiality of all information they come across during their volunteering
- Not share personal information about beneficiaries, donors, or other volunteers without proper authorisation
- Handle personal data in accordance with the Charity's Data Protection Policy
- Continue to maintain confidentiality after leaving their volunteer role

The Charity will handle volunteers' personal data in accordance with data protection legislation and the Data Protection Policy.

19. Review

This policy will be reviewed by the Board of Trustees every two years, or sooner if there are significant changes to the Charity's volunteer activities or relevant best practice guidance.

20. Approval and Version History

Version	Date	Approved By	Changes
1.0	01/02/2026	Board of Trustees	Initial policy

21. Trustee Declaration

We, the undersigned trustees of Gloucester Zakat Charity, confirm that we have read, understood, and approved this Volunteer Management Policy and commit to its implementation.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Mr Abdullah Abdul Samad Patel	Chair	A. Patel	01/02/2026
Mr Kamel Boulkenafet	Trustee	K. Boulkenafet	01/02/2026
Mr Hashim Moolla	Trustee	H. Moolla	01/02/2026
Mr Farouq Ginwalla	Trustee	F. Ginwalla	01/02/2026
Ms Mariam Qureshi	Trustee	M. Qureshi	01/02/2026

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